

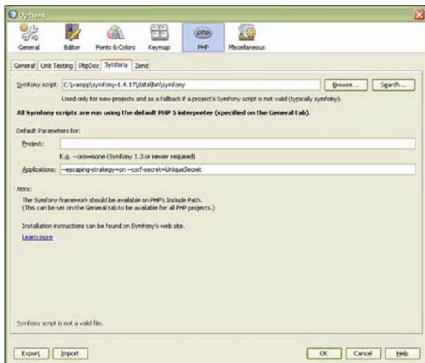


Figure 3: Setting the Symfony script path

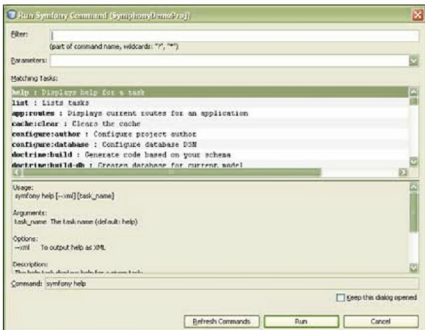


Figure 4: Running Symfony commands

Now all you have to do is to write your application, without bothering much about the logistics.

Running Symfony commands

To run a Symfony command, you can simply go to the project you have created in NetBeans, right-

click, and select **Symfony → Run Command**. This opens up a list of all

the Symfony commands available (see Figure 4), and you can just run a command without having to remember the syntax, or type it at a command prompt.

Debugging the project

To debug projects, change the `xampp/php/php.ini` file. Just find and uncomment the lines as follows:

```
zend_extension = "XAMPP_HOME\php\ext\
php_xdebug.dll"
xdebug.remote_host=localhost #Change
from "localhost" to "127.0.0.1"
xdebug.remote_enable = 0 #Change 0 to 1.
xdebug.remote_handler = "dbg"
xdebug.remote_port = 9000
```

Then save this and restart XAMPP. Now you are ready to debug the project. Just click **Debug Project** in the Symfony main window, and execution stops at the first line of `index.php`, since this is the default controller in Symfony. You can now go step by step to check your code flow. If you don't want execution to stop at the first line, but at your own breakpoint, just un-check 'Stop at the first line' in the **Debugging** tab in **Tools → Options → PHP → General**. When faced with any problems while setting up the debugging function, you can refer to <http://goo.gl/dzeBE>.

This completes our development environment set-up. Since each component has a robust community behind it, the chance that you will get stuck mid-way is pretty remote. This is the power of open source. I hope you like this article, and you use this set-up to develop applications. Any queries, suggestions, or feedback is most welcome. **END** 

By: Nitish Tiwari

The author is a FOSS enthusiast, currently working in a FOSS start-up. He is fond of bikes, travelling, Bollywood music, and of course, computers. He also runs www.opensourceblogs.com, a blog on open source tools. You can mail him at nitish.tiwari@technocube.in.